

The Coca-Cola Company

1Q25 Earnings Prep

Our 1Q +5.8% OSG is ahead of Consensus that has continued to tick down (now +5.2%), although we're in line on EPS of \$0.72 for the quarter.

We continue to like KO given 1) our confidence in KO's OSG that screens highly attractive across the group (even under a variety of different consumer environment scenarios from here) and 2) the relative insulation that KO's global portfolio and footprint enjoys to various headline risks that weigh more harshly on other pockets of Staples (e.g. tariffs, GLP1s and broader health & wellness trends in the US).

Current Consensus Expectations

---- 1Q25 ----

- 1Q25 EPS: \$0.72 [\$0.70-\$0.77 range, Barclays = \$0.72]
- 1Q25 sales growth: -0.8% [-3.1% to +5.1% range, Barclays = -0.3%, +5.8% organic]

---- 2025 ----

- 2025 EPS: \$2.96 [\$2.94-\$3.00 range, Barclays = \$2.94]
- 2025 sales growth: +2.4% [+1.0% to +4.4% range, Barclays = +1.5%, +5.2% organic]

---- 2026 ----

- 2026 EPS: \$3.19 [\$3.10-\$3.26 range, Barclays = \$3.20]
- 2026 sales growth: +5.2% [Barclays = +5.7%, +5.7% organic]

Source: Consensus figures from Bloomberg

Our Thoughts

KO's outlook feels relatively credible and largely within KO's control to execute on regardless of the dynamic macro environment – and this is precisely the kind of defense and visibility that had made this one of our most favored names within the Staples universe this year – even after moderately tempering our OSG outlook for the next several quarters in late March ([US CHPC & Beverages: Spring Cleaning](#), 03/26/25). We continue to like KO given 1) our confidence in KO's OSG that screens highly attractive across the group (irrespective of how the consumer environment progresses from here) and 2) the relative insulation that KO's global portfolio and footprint enjoys to various headline risks that are weighing on the rest of Staples (e.g. tariffs, GLP1s and broader health & wellness trends in the US). That is not to say KO is necessarily completely immune, but we see much less downside risk to KO's guide vs. many other companies, particularly if a weaker USD tempers the outlook for a 6-7% drag from currency on EPS - although we'd think hedges in place limit potential upside from a weaker USD.

KO	OVERWEIGHT
U.S. CHPC & Beverages	NEUTRAL
Price Target	USD 73.00
Price (25-Apr-25)	USD 71.91
Potential Upside/Downside	+1.5%
Source: Bloomberg, Barclays Research	

U.S. CHPC & Beverages

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As a reminder, in late March we lowered our 1Q25E EPS -2c to \$0.72 due to a more measured stance towards OSG compared to what we had contemplated in immediately following 4Q24 earnings. We had softened our consolidated OSG by ~250 bps to +5.7% (from +8.2%), with our revisions broad-based across the footprint. The largest change had been in Latin America, where we look for OSG of +13.5% (from +20% previously). We lowered several other segments' OSG in late March by -200 bps, including North America (to +3.5%) and BIG (to +5%). With respect to the former, we think certain false headlines around ICE raids that then translated into broader boycott calls could have contributed to a real (but transitory) headwind for the business in certain pockets of the country, but we don't expect it was large enough to move the needle from a big picture perspective. We also had tempered the other remaining divisions by ~150 bps at the end of last month, including EMEA (to +7%), APAC (to +3%) and Global Ventures (to +3%). The cuts skewed towards volumes, with estimated consolidated concentrate having landed at +0.2% (from +2.5%) while price/mix held in around +5.6%. Adjusting for the two fewer selling days in 1Q25, total estimated volumes are +2.2%. We tempered our FX drag in late March by ~10 bps to a -3.7% headwind (vs. KO's 3-4% guide), which coupled with a -2.4% structural drag from lapping some remaining refranchising initiated in 2024 (namely Philippines that closed in late February) we look for a net sales decline of -0.4%. Moving down the P&L, we look for a gross margin of 62.8% that reflects +30 bps of underlying expansion, a +75 bps tailwind from refranchising, and a ~ 50 bps headwind from currency. SG&A at 29.5% of sales translates to an operating margin of 33.3%.

What Matters Most To Us

- Perspective on recent volumes trends and consumer health across key markets
- Impacts from global trade war & also the latest on FX outlook
- Progress on US focus areas, particularly Fairlife

Guidance Recap

---- 1Q25 ----

- Currency: 3-4% headwind to revenues; 5-6% headwind to EPS (based on rates as of February and inclusive of hedged positions)
- Structural: 2-3% headwind to comparable net revenues; 2-3% headwind to EPS

---- 2025 ----

- Organic revenue growth: +5-6%
- EPS growth: +2-3% (currency neutral +8-10%)
- Currency: 3-4% headwind to revenues and 6-7% headwind to earnings (both including the impact of hedged positions)
- Structural: Slight headwind to comparable net revenues and EPS
- Inflation: Commodity inflation more in the ~LSD range
- Interest expense: elevated vs. prior year but not expecting significant BTL de-leverage
- Tax rate: ~20.8%, not including any impact of ongoing tax litigation
- FCF: \$9.5 billion, excluding Fairlife contingent consideration
- OCF: \$11.7 billion, excluding Fairlife contingent consideration
- Capex: \$2.2 billion

---- Long-Term Guidance ----

- Organic revenue growth +4-6%
- Comparable, FX-neutral operating income growth 6% to 8%
- Comparable, FX-neutral EPS growth +7-9%
- Adjusted free cash flow conversion 90% to 95%
- CapEx at 4.5% to 5% of net revenue

- Target of 2 to 2.5x net debt leverage

KO 1Q25 Earnings Call Details

Tuesday, April 29th @ 8:30 a.m. ET - US: 888-415-4465; International: 646-960-0140; Passcode: 6819315

As always, please feel free to call with any questions or comments.

Best,

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The Coca-Cola Company (KO, 25-Apr-2025, USD 71.91), Overweight/Neutral, A/CD/CE/D/E/J/K/L/M/N

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U.S. CHPC & Beverages

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Constellation Brands (STZ)	Coty Inc. (COTY)	Edgewell Personal Care Company (EPC)
Energizer Holdings, Inc (ENR)	International Flavors & Fragrances (IFF)	Kenvue Inc. (KVUE)
Keurig Dr Pepper (KDP)	Kimberly-Clark Corp. (KMB)	Molson Coors Beverage Company (TAP)
Newell Brands Inc. (NWL)	ODDITY Tech Ltd. (ODD)	Olaplex Holdings, Inc. (OLPX)

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The Coca-Cola Company (KO)

Procter & Gamble (PG)
The Estée Lauder Companies (EL)

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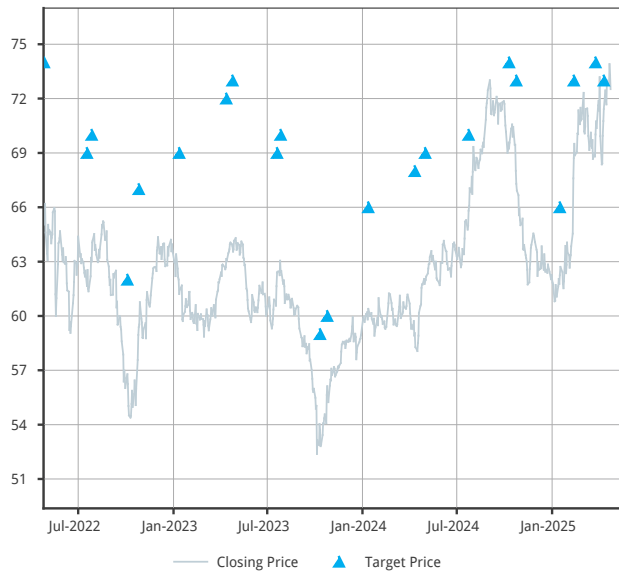
Stock Rating: **OVERWEIGHT**

Industry View: **NEUTRAL**

Closing Price: **USD 71.91** (25-Apr-2025)

Rating and Price Target Chart - USD (as of 25-Apr-2025)

Currency=USD



Source: IDC, Barclays Research

[Link to Barclays Live for interactive charting](#)

Publication Date	Closing Price*	Rating	Adjusted Price Target
11-Apr-2025	70.76		73.00
26-Mar-2025	68.95		74.00
12-Feb-2025	67.60		73.00
16-Jan-2025	61.77		66.00
24-Oct-2024	68.01		73.00
10-Oct-2024	69.57		74.00
24-Jul-2024	64.96		70.00
01-May-2024	61.77		69.00
11-Apr-2024	59.72		68.00
12-Jan-2024	59.81		66.00
25-Oct-2023	55.64		60.00
11-Oct-2023	54.03		59.00
27-Jul-2023	63.05		70.00
20-Jul-2023	61.64		69.00
25-Apr-2023	63.95		73.00
13-Apr-2023	62.69		72.00
12-Jan-2023	61.21		69.00
26-Oct-2022	58.95		67.00
04-Oct-2022	56.78		62.00
27-Jul-2022	63.21		70.00
18-Jul-2022	61.65		69.00

On 28-Apr-2022, prior to any intra-day change that may have been published, the rating for this security was Overweight, and the adjusted price target was 74.00.

Source: Bloomberg, Barclays Research

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